



EMPLOYER ENGAGEMENT QUICK GUIDE

TYPES OF LABOR MARKET INFORMATION

Labor Market Information (LMI) is data about labor supply and demand, earnings, job outlook, and demographics of the labor force. In other words, it provides a snapshot of where there is and likely will continue to be a need for skilled job seekers. LMI can be found from a variety of official and unofficial sources. Below is content on sources of labor market information in three categories: Local, Traditional, and Real-Time.

LOCAL LABOR MARKET INTELLIGENCE

Local labor market intelligence or Agency Business Relations LMI is collected by VR staff, CRPs and other partners that are directly working with and networking within the employer community. It's word of mouth intelligence and sources include personal networks, local employers themselves, chambers of commerce, and industry associations. It is often more nuanced than other sources of LMI, as it reflects a timelier picture of employer labor needs, projections and reflects current job openings and opportunities, sometimes before the positions have even been posted. For those working directly with employers, this type of LMI provides a landscape of your local community and information that can be useful as you reach out and connect with employers. A related resource brief can be found at Explore VR. **"Hidden Gems: Using "Agency Business Relations LMI"** describes sources of Agency Business Relations Labor Market Information and how to use them. This resource can be found at <https://www.explorevr.org/toolkits/labor-market-information/metrics>



TRADITIONAL LABOR MARKET INTELLIGENCE

Traditional LMI sources typically are Federal or State entities that collect local, state, and national employment and workforce data and then analyze that data to report on and project labor trends, wage averages and upcoming labor demands. It includes past and projected trends on hundreds of standardized industries and occupations. The data has been collected for decades so it is generally very accurate and complete although it does not always account for current, to the minute updates. Here are just a few of the resources available:



- » The US Bureau of Labor Statistics Occupational Employment Statistics (www.bls.gov/oes/home.htm) produces employment and wage estimates annually for nearly 800 occupations. These estimates are available at the national, state, metropolitan and nonmetropolitan levels. National occupational estimates for specific industries are also available.
- » The US Department of Labor Occupations Statistics (<https://www.dol.gov/general/topic/statistics/occupations>) hosts a variety of statistics and webpages relating to LMI and publishes a large amount of information on employment and wages by occupation, including career information, employment levels and projections, and various types of earnings data. They have

The contents of this factsheet do not represent legal advice and is provided for general informational purposes only. For specific references to this and related laws, please verify your state statutes and laws, as well as consult with your agency/ business attorney or certified public accountant.

several helpful tools.

- The Occupational Outlook Handbook (<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/>) looks at occupation groups by wages, projected growth and # of jobs. They also provide information about workplace injuries and illnesses.
 - The Career One Stop website (<https://www.careeronestop.org/>) filters and categorizes the information by various subtopics including: going back to work, career changer, Veterans, Workers with criminal histories, entry-level, credential seekers, older workers, youth, self-employment, and workers with disabilities.
- » Lastly, each state has a research and analysis bureau, which is great for looking at LMI state-wide but also narrowing the focus to regions of the state. Local Labor Economists in those departments are a great resource and are readily available to provide guidance on interpreting the data.

REAL-TIME LABOR MARKET INTELLIGENCE

Real-time LMI is drawn from online job postings for a region, using technology called “spidering”, which searches the internet based on user’s chosen criteria and renders current job postings related to that criterion. It’s very timely but sometimes incomplete. It gives a glimpse into current trends based primarily on recent want ads and a database of resumes. It provides information on employer demand, new and emerging in-demand skills and credentials, job titles, industry trends, and educational requirements. Information that is often missing is how many positions the employer is looking to fill and what criteria need to be met to qualify for positions (i.e. certifications, background checks, etc.)



- » The Career Index Plus (TCI+) (https://www.thecareerindex.com/dsp_intro.cfm) is a career information system that collects LMI from a host of resources and deposits it onto a single site. It partnered with the Workforce Innovation Technical Assistance Center or WINTAC and created tools specific to VR including tutorial videos. and offers the option of linking VR staff searches with job seeker searches that can be saved. It’s a hybrid of traditional and Real-time LMI since it pulls information about job clusters and skills from traditional sources and current jobs and training sites.
- » The Employment and Training Administration (ETA) of the Department of Labor has created a couple of resources that are helpful for Real Time LMI.
- The **WorkforceGPS Guide to Real-Time LMI** links you to tools and dashboards that provide real-time information along with other real-time indicators. It also provides help on how to use those tools. This resource can be found on the WorkforceGPS site (https://www.workforcegps.org/resources/2020/06/03/02/02/Guide_to_RealTime_LMI). It includes common uses, successes, and challenges of Real time LMI.
 - The **WorkforceGPS, Data-Informed Quality Business Services for Employer Engagement** and Customized Employment provides a wide range of data to target business engagement strategies and activities to help solve unique business situations at the local and regional community level. You can find this resource at https://www.workforcegps.org/resources/2020/06/03/02/02/Guide_to_RealTime_LMI.



The Program on Innovative Rehabilitation Training on Employer Engagement is a project of ExploreVR at the Institute for Community Inclusion, UMass Boston. ExploreVR offers VR agencies easy and convenient access to a range of VR research, related data, training and tools for planning, evaluation, and decision-making. Funding for this project is provided by the Rehabilitation Services Administration (RSA) Grant #H263C190012.